尘埃与星的边界
Between Dusts and Stars

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序幕:拖延症候群
Prologue: The Procrastination Syndrome COL-307001

寒冽的风扑面，你的眼眸被蒙了一层雾，模糊、浑浊。
An icy wind blasts you in the face, and a mist fogs up your eyes.

你发觉铅重的腿在挪动，你不清楚你在哪儿，你只知道你在动。
You don't know where you are, but with leaden steps you press on.

你能隐隐感觉自己去往某个高处，总之不能呆在此处——对，绝不是此处。
You can vaguely feel yourself moving to a higher place. You can't stay here. You definitely have to get away.

瞧，一条粗砺的麻绳从高处抛了下来，它牢固、结实，在呼啸的风中摇荡——它在向你招手。
Look! A thick rope is thrown down from above. Strong and sturdy, it waves at you as it swings in the wind.

你的双腿在打战，眼神开始失焦，血液凝固。你还在犹豫。
Your legs are trembling, your eyes are losing focus, and your blood is running cold. You stop and you hesitate.

一扇逃生门，你不想试试抓住它?
An escape. Reach for it?

选项 / Choices

1. 抓住它，没什么好失落的
1. Grab on. You have nothing to lose.

2. 无视它，垂死的人亦有尊严
2. Ignore it. Even the dying should remain dignified.

分支 / Branch 1

> 你死死抓住了它，如果可以，你甚至想用上那排牙齿。
> You reach for the rope and hold on for dear life. You would have grabbed it with your teeth if you could.
>
> 可它似乎并非看上的那般结实，啪——你听见鱼线断开的声音。
> Sadly, it's not as sturdy as it looks. CRACK! You hear the snap of a fishing line.

分支 / Branch 2

> 你跪倒在地上，匍匐着前进，骄傲充满你的胸腔。你口干舌燥，却如饮甘泉。
> You kneel down and begin to crawl, chest swelling with pride. Your mouth is dry, but it's as if you are drinking from a delicious spring.
>
> 风拍打着你，它们躁动、永无止境，而你被席卷着滚落向悬崖边缘!
> The unrelenting wind hits you and sweeps you towards the edge of the cliff.

共同接续 / Shared continuation

突如其来的下坠、下坠！慌张、恐惧的情绪盖过所有，迅速占领大脑。
Suddenly you're falling! Panic and fear overwhelm you and take hold of your mind.

研究所
Research Laboratory

伽菈波那：——!
Kaalaa Baunaa: ——!

研究所的深夜，一如往常，寂静悄然。
Late at night in the research institute, all is quiet as usual.

资料与计划书，它们被压在手臂底下已久，暗示着噩梦的源头。
The documents and proposals under your arms have been there for too long. They were probably the cause of the nightmare.

伽菈波那： 4 点 15 分……睡了将近 4 个小时?!
Kaalaa Baunaa: 04:15... I slept for almost 4 hours?!

伽菈波那： 我刚才明明只是打了个盹儿……
Kaalaa Baunaa: It was supposed to be a quick nap...

研究所中响起其他人微弱的鼾息，环视四周，他们安详地酣睡着。
You hear faint snoring from all around—the rest of the staff is sound asleep.

伽菈波那： 呼……必须打起精神，计划的期限来得比我想象的更快……
Kaalaa Baunaa: *deep breath* Wake up, Kaalaa. The deadline is coming sooner than I thought ...

残缺的营养棒
Gnawed Cereal Bar COL-307002

半截营养棒躺倒在桌面上，它干瘪、僵硬，即便它半褪去了外衣，看上去也并不可口。
Half a cereal bar lies on the table, dry, stale, and half exposed. It doesn't look very appetizing.

伽菈波那： 这是前天的……算了，现在也没什么东西好挑的。
Kaalaa Baunaa: It's from the day before yesterday... Well, beggars can't be choosers.

伽菈波那： 嚼嚼……嗯，这个味道……?
Kaalaa Baunaa: *chews* Hmm, it tastes...

伽菈波那： 比我想象的好吃……很走运。
Kaalaa Baunaa: Much better than I thought ... Lucky.

你将营养棒握在手上，仔细观察，似乎发现有些微的异样……
You examine the cereal bar and notice that something's a bit...off...

研究员达莎： 加拉瓦！你让我们整个团队都为你的错误买单。
Researcher Daksha: Gaurav! Now the whole team has to pay for your screw up!

研究员达莎： 连单体恒星和分光双星都能混淆，你是在牛棚里读的大学吗?
Researcher Daksha: You can't even distinguish a single star from a binary star?! What academy in its right mind ever let you in? Cowbridge?

见习生加拉瓦： 抱，抱歉！
Intern Gaurav: S-Sorry!

研究员希玛妮： 还有，研究所不是宠物店，记得把它拴在门口……
Researcher Himani: And we're working in an institution, not a pet store. Remember to tie it to the door ...

微小的差错，很有可能昭示着一场集体性的彻夜不眠。
Even the smallest mistake can result in a sleepless night for everyone.

见习生加拉瓦： 伽菈波那女士……
Intern Gaurav: Ms. Kaalaa Baunaa...

你两手接过咖啡。
You take the coffee with both hands.

你的膝下仍紧随着那只热情过头的小狗，它显然并不顾及这份尴尬。
The overly enthusiastic puppy is still at your knees, oblivious to the unpleasant state of affairs.

伽菈波那：我们把望远镜作为眼眸，借由数千年的天文观测数据为阶梯，才得以一瞥宇宙的深处。
Kaalaa Baunaa: These telescopes are our eyes, using thousands of years of observational data to guide us as we peer into the depths of the universe.

伽菈波那：即便我们始终未曾“亲眼”看见。
Kaalaa Baunaa: Well, we have never seen it with our "own eyes", though.

见习生加拉瓦：可是我分明……！
Intern Gaurav: But I'm sure I—

伽菈波那：——请不要再忘记分析星体谱线位置的变化，这理应是你的另一双眼眸。
Kaalaa Baunaa: —Again, please do NOT forget to conduct analysis on the changes in the spectral lines. They should be treated like your second pair of eyes.

见习生加拉瓦：我明白了……
Intern Gaurav: Yes, miss...

加拉瓦低垂着头，从口袋掏出营养棒，小狗热情地凑了过去。
Gaurav lowers his head and pulls a cereal bar out of his pocket, drawing the friendly puppy's attention.

他漫不经心地喂食着小狗，旋即又被其他研究员喊了过去。
He absent-mindedly feeds the puppy until researchers call him away.

伽菈波那：所以……
Kaalaa Baunaa: Wait a minute—

伽菈波那：你转过营养棒的侧面，上面陷有参差不齐的犬牙印……
Kaalaa Baunaa: You turn the cereal bar over and see jagged, gnawing marks on it...

晕倒的人
The Comatose Person COL-307003

这位研究员躺倒在地上，轻轻吐息，有如婴儿般地酣睡。只是成年的身躯使这件事显得没那么温馨与……雅观。
A researcher is fast asleep on the floor. She is breathing steadily like a baby, only her adult size makes the scene not so adorable or...appropriate.

选项 / Choices
1. 唤醒她
1. Wake her up

伽菈波那：达莎，你可以去会议室休息。
Kaalaa Baunaa: Go sleep in the conference room, Daksha.

她揉着眼睛，似乎还没意识到身处何处。
Rubbing her eyes, Daksha doesn't seem to realize where she is.

等看清四周，她惊讶地跳起来，一副难以置信的表情。
After finally figuring it out, she jumps to her feet in great surprise.

研究员达莎：天呐……我在地上睡过去了？
Researcher Daksha: Oh gosh... Did I fall asleep on the floor?

伽菈波那：你可以早点回家，你的汇报不是已经完成了吗？
Kaalaa Baunaa: Why don't you go home? I thought you already finished the report.

研究员达莎： 不，库玛尔对我的科研方向有一些新的“建议”……我的研究内容要被推倒重来。
Researcher Daksha: No, Kumar gave me some new "suggestions" for my research direction ... I have to start all over again.

伽菈波那： ……她怎么又……?!
Kaalaa Baunaa: ... She did that again?!

研究员达莎： 这该是我在这里做的最后一个项目……没错……我早该这样做……
Researcher Daksha: This is going to be my last project here ... That's right ... I should've done this earlier ...

她埋头到研究当中，对所有一切都视若不见。你深呼一口气，又向别处走去。
With that, she buries herself in research, ignoring you. You take a deep breath and walk away.

白色纸团
White Paper Ball COL-307004

这些卷成一团的稿纸是研究过程中的边角料，角落里的垃圾桶收留了它们。
These crumpled drafts are research waste. They are now in the trash.

其中一张泛黄的纸吸引了你的注意，这是你亲手丢掉的东西，可那是什么?
A yellowed piece of paper catches your attention. Something you threw away, what was it again?

选项 / Choices

1. 捡起它
1. Pick it up.

2. 对它不感兴趣
2. Not interested.

分支 / Branch 1

“伽菈波那：荣升二级研究员的达恩正式向你发起挑战！届时‘阿耶波多奖’的失败者将为赢家的咖啡随叫随到！——达恩。”
"Kaalaa Baunaa: Fresh off a promotion, the Senior Researcher Daane formally challenges you! The loser of the Aryabhata Award will be at the winner's beck and call for hot coffee! -Daane."

你嗤之以鼻，将它揉成一团，送回垃圾桶。
You snort disdainfully, crumple it into a ball, and throw it back in the trash.

分支 / Branch 2

你已忘记其中的内容，但它带给你的不快不言而喻。
You already forgot what it is about, but apparently, you didn't like it.

这就够了，让它躺在那儿吧，权当一块破抹布。
Not in the mood. Just let garbage lie where it belongs.

落幕:拖延症候群
Epilogue: The Procrastination Syndrome COL-307005

大脑完全苏醒，是时候回到位置上继续研究了。
Now that you're fully awake, it's time to get back to work.

选项 / Choices

1. 不，我想再推迟一些
1. No, I need another five minutes.

2. 事不宜迟
2. Go straight back to your desk.

分支 / Branch 1

研究室外漆黑一片，但比起这个密闭、沉闷的空间，或许外面更能让你对工作产生头绪……
It's pitch black outside the institute, but compared to this enclosed, suffocating space, the open air might offer a breath of inspiration...

我们总需要点灵感，朋友。而紧盯着工作，灵感只会像一个害羞的女士躲在后头。
We could always use a little inspiration, my friend. Focusing too much on work will only scare the muse away.

分支 / Branch 2

你踏上了长达 10 米的归途，这段路途艰难、曲折，意外丛生、危机四伏……
You embark on your ten-meter journey, an arduous, terrifying expedition strewn with difficulties, accidents, and even danger...

你走到月光铺成的地板上，不禁抬头仰望，转瞬间你的思绪飘入了浩渺无垠的夜空。
As you walk across the moonlit ground, you can't help but look up. The next second, your mind is flying amongst the stars in the boundless sky.

快停下！
Stop!

快停——
Sto—

共同接续 / Shared continuation

……

...

你恢复意识时，已矗立在研究所的门外，迎接你的将是工作之外无比广阔的宇宙。
You are already outside the gates when you come to your senses. You are greeted by something that transcends work—the limitless universe.

伽菈波那： ……我到底有多久没来过这儿了？
Kaalaa Baunaa: ...How long has it been since I came here?

数不清的在研究所的蜗壳里，观测的日日夜夜。
The countless days and nights observing the stars within the confines of the institute...

伽菈波那： 我都快忘了……原来看星星需要把头仰得这样高。
Kaalaa Baunaa: I forgot how much I have to crane my neck to see the stars.

可埋头在资料之中，远比抬头寻获更多。
But when I bury my head in data, I can discover so much more.

伽菈波那： 我该多来这儿看看。
Kaalaa Baunaa: I should come here more often.

但不可拖延的事物，始终紧随。
But, there's always something pressing at hand.

伽菈波那： 机会难得……
Kaalaa Baunaa: Such a rare opportunity...

刻不容缓的计划已——
The urgent proposals are—

伽菈波那： 应该还能把那些星星都找回来。
Kaalaa Baunaa: I should be able to find all those stars again.

“啪”，你瘫躺下来，将所有声音抛之脑后。
"Thud." You collapse, and all your worries fade into the background.

可遗忘与抛却，并不能解决那只可怕的巨兽……
But simply ignoring and dodging problems won't help you get rid of that terrible monster...

研究所内，备受冷落的计划书开始哀嚎……
Inside the institution, the proposals you ignored are starting to groan ...

它们显然难以忍受这份刻意的忽略，饥饿催促着它们寻找着罪魁祸首。随着欲望的高涨，身躯也愈发庞大……
They can no longer stand this deliberate neglect. Driven by hunger, they grow larger and larger as they search for the one to blame ...

——终于，它们冲破了躯壳的束缚，贪婪地追向你……
Until finally, they break the restraints of their vessel and come after you with ravenous intent...

3#1
3#1

序幕:零星的闪烁
Prologue: Twinkling Stars COL-307006

伽菈波那： 大犬座 α、猎户座 α……人类用短浅的视线度量它们，看似如此接近……
Kaalaa Baunaa: Sirius, Betelgeuse ... They look so close to each other in the eyes of mankind ...

伽菈波那： ——却相隔着六百余光年。
Kaalaa Baunaa: ... But they are actually over 600 light years apart.

无垠的宇宙、空旷的平原、安静的卫生间……置身其中，无人能避免陷入对生命的沉思。
Whether immersed in the boundless universe, an expansive plain, or a quiet bathroom...one cannot escape the contemplation of life.

悄然之间，嗷嗷待哺的“野兽”匍匐而至，缠住矗立在星空下的双腿……
Under the cover of the starry night, the hungry "beasts" crawl to your side, entangling your legs ...

计划书： 饿……饿，计划……禁止！拖延 &%*&*……!
Proposal: Hungry ... Hungry! Forbid ... project, delay &%*&*...!

伽菈波那： 什……?!
Kaalaa Baunaa: What...?!

它饥肠辘辘，无数只手捆住了你的身躯，试图将你拉回名为研究所的恐怖洞窟……
Countless ravenous hands grab hold of you, trying to drag you back to that terrifying lair known as the research institute...

这是拖延者所必须背负的宿命……
Such is the fate of the procrastinator ...

伽菈波那： 放松对工作而言……！
Kaalaa Baunaa: Relaxing is important for—

计划书： 期限 &%*&*……
Proposal: Deadline &%*&* ...

你向前挣扎，可在劫难逃……
You struggle to run away, but they just won't let you go ...

黑暗掩盖双眼，你明白自己正驶向名为工作的目的地。
Darkness envelops your eyes and you feel yourself being dragged back to work.

刹车、方向盘都已经失灵……唯一能做的，是别让它再进一步压垮自己的神经。
You can neither stop nor turn around ... The only thing you can do now is to prevent yourself from being crushed further in this mental car crash.

一沓资料
Pile of Documents COL-307007

成叠的资料数据，你一筹莫展、毫无头绪。
Looking at the piles of data, you are feeling at a loss.

万事总有起点，让脑子跟上你的手活动起来吧……
But you have to take the first step anyway. Now start the engine of your brain and try to keep up with your hands ...

选项 / Choices
1. 整理数据
1. Organize data

伽菈波那： 5 月份的观测数据，那天受乌云的影响白跑了一趟……
Kaalaa Baunaa: The data in May. We saw nothing that day thanks to the dark clouds ...

你记起那天，天文台涌来一群孩子，他们围绕着天文望远镜和各种器材，探头探脑。
You remember that day. A bunch of children swarmed into the observatory, surrounded the telescopes and equipment, and poked around curiously.

天文台
Observatory

这些孩子家境丰裕，有些出身自教授家庭，更多的出于父母对班纳尔大学的慷慨投资，而受邀前来。
They were children of wealthy families; some were children of professors, others were invited because of their parents' generous donations to Banner University.

踏入观察宇宙的门扉，普通孩子需要付出更大的代价。而她知道，这些孩子却很快就会在新的见识中淡忘这个枯燥的地方。
Ordinary children had to pay a higher price to observe the universe. But she knew that, distracted by shiny new discoveries, the kids would soon pay no attention to the dreariness of this place.

教师： 很不凑巧，天气很糟糕，我们得改天再来了。
Teacher: Unfortunately, because of the bad weather, we have to come here another day.

孩子们不约而同地发出哀叹，又再次兴冲冲地一起跑向天文台的出口。
The children sighed in unison, and hurried to the observatory exit.

一位女孩驻足在原地，揪着脏兮兮的衣服，张望着这高她半身的望远镜。
One girl stayed, clutching her dirty clothes, staring at the telescope twice her size.

伽菈波那：你该和他们一块儿回去了。
Kaalaa Baunaa: You should go with them.

女孩：呃……你是这里的管理员吗？这个大家伙真漂亮。
Girl: Um ... Are you the admin here? I love this big girl. She's beautiful.

伽菈波那：你的眼光很不错……不过，我不是管理员。
Kaalaa Baunaa: Nice taste ... but I'm not the admin.

女孩：谢天谢地。为了这个大家伙，我可没少跟在那帮吵闹鬼背后吃苦头——我是跟在他们屁股后面进来的。
Girl: That's a relief. The things I had to go through to get here to see this, following those noisy brats and sneaking in behind them and all.

伽菈波那：……你知道这距离山底下有 20 多公里路程，对吧？没人来接你吗？
Kaalaa Baunaa: ...You know this place is over 20 km from the foot of the mountain, don't you? Is no one picking you up?

女孩：我可以走回去……你能让我偷偷看一眼吗，就一眼？
Girl: I can walk ... May I take a look at the sky, just for a second?

你皱起眉头，望向乌云密布的窗外，又瞥了一眼女孩脚踝上星星点点的泥巴。
Frowning at the request, you looked at the dark clouds covering the sky, and glanced at the specks of mud on the girl's ankles.

女孩：求你了——
Girl: Pleeeeeeease...

她仰起头，瞪大了仿佛要泪汪汪的双眼，拽着你的衣角。
She looked up at you, eyes wide open as if sparkling with tears, and tugged at your clothes.

伽菈波那：你得答应必须坐我的车回去。
Kaalaa Baunaa: Promise me you'll take my ride back home.

女孩：一言为定！
Girl: Deal!

你回忆起那个渴求的眼神和雀跃的身影，这让你在这冰冷的研究所中为之一振。
The memory of her eager gaze and spirited figure brings warmth to the cold institution.

整理观测数据、分析星体运行轨迹……你仿佛找回了某种似曾相识的——冲动。
Organizing observational data, analyzing celestial orbits...you seem to have found some of the drive you once had.

计算机
Calculator COL-307008

屏幕上显示着未完成的星体运行轨迹模型，你得把数据逐一填入，再加以运算——这确实是一份枯燥的工作。
An unfinished orbit model is shown on the screen. You have to fill in the data one by one and complete the calculation—a tedious task indeed.

选项 / Choices
1. 填入数据
1. Fill in the data.

一行，两行……你的双臂开始酸痛，但为时尚早。
One row, two rows... Your arms are getting sore, but you're only just getting started.

库玛尔要求你们必须亲自输入观测数据，这本该是见习生的工作……这份固执让不少同事选择辞职。
It's Kumar's requirement that you must enter the observation data yourself, even though the job is supposed to be done by interns ... Her stubbornness has led many colleagues to resign.

库玛尔：哼，对待观测数据得像对你的孩子一样，你会把它丢给一个沿街乞讨的乞丐吗？——抱歉，无意冒犯，加拉瓦。
Kumar: Hmph, researchers should treat the observation data like their own child. Will you leave your child to the homeless on the street? Sorry, no offense, Gaurav.

见习生加拉瓦：……
Intern Gaurav: ...

研究员希玛妮：库玛尔，为了填观测数据，我已经两天没有回过家了。
Researcher Himani: Kumar, I've already been away from home for two whole days, just to fill in the observation data.

研究员希玛妮：我现在只知道，我家里有一个货真价实的孩子，不是这该死的比喻象征。而如果我再不回去，天知道保姆还会怎么教他。
Researcher Himani: Now all I know is, I have a real child at home. I need to take care of him instead of your damn metaphor. I should be with him now, before the nanny puts more funny ideas into his head.

库玛尔：瞧，你该解决的问题是找一个有大学文凭的保姆或者丈夫，不是吗？
Kumar: So, the solution to your problem is to simply find yourself a nanny or a husband with an education degree, right?

希玛妮的脸涨得通红。
Himani's cheeks flushed red.

研究员希玛妮：你知道吗？我不干了。*你的库玛尔！
Researcher Himani: You know what? I quit. F**k you Kumar!

库玛尔看她摔门而去，命令加拉瓦收拾好她的私人物品，像垃圾一般丢到门外。
She stormed out the door. Kumar ordered Gaurav to pack up her things and throw them out like garbage.

你看见希玛妮蹲在地上，一颤一颤地抽泣，你走上前去。
Himani is crouched on the ground, sobbing. You walked up to her.

伽菈波那：……
Kaalaa Baunaa: ...

研究员希玛妮：……我不会回来了。
Researcher Himani: ... I won't come back.

她扶住额头，仿佛头痛欲裂。
With a hand on her forehead, she seemed to be suffering a severe headache.

研究员希玛妮：库玛尔该知道，不是所有人都像她……和你一样愿意把整个生命都献给那摸不着的宇宙尽头……
Researcher Himani: Kumar should know, not everyone is like her... and you, willing to dedicate your whole life to the mysteries of the universe...

研究员希玛妮：我拥有自己的生活……而她随意地践踏我的尊严——这是不可原谅的。
Researcher Himani: I have my own life...yet she trampled on my dignity. I will never forgive her.

自那之后，你再也没有见过她。
You never saw her again after that.

目光抽回屏幕，你的手指机械地敲击着键盘。
Your mind has returned to reality. You look back at the screen, your fingers typing mechanically.

——很好，在节奏的敲击声中，数据填入完成，接下来便交由这个大家伙处理出完整的模型了。
Good. All the data has been filled in to the rhythm of your keystrokes. Now you just need to wait for the big guy to generate the complete model.

落幕:零星的闪烁
Epilogue: Twinkling Stars COL-307009

计划书：饱 &%*&*……呼呼呼。
Proposal: So full &%*&*... *snores*.

怪物终于安静下来，宛如巨兽陷入了沉沉的睡眠。你将资料收纳进文件夹，关闭电脑。
The monster finally quiets down, like a giant beast fallen into a deep slumber. You pack up the documents and turn off the computer.

——而事情远没有结束，你知道噩梦还在后头。但它终是告了一段落……
You know that this is far from over, a nightmare still looms ahead, and you've only cleared one of many hurdles to come...

伽菈波那：呼——
Kaalaa Baunaa: *sighs*

临近人们苏醒的时刻，而你此刻却需要一次无人打搅的美梦。
Your colleagues are about to wake up, yet what you need is a dream in quietude.

你钻进与世隔绝的车里，旋即被人敲晕一般，沉入意识的深海。
You get into the car and isolate yourself. Soon you pass out and sink into the depths of your consciousness.

3#1
3#1

序幕:对峙时刻
Prologue: Confrontation COL-307010

班纳尔大学演讲厅
Bannar University Lecture Hall

人潮涌动的教学楼，你抱着文件夹走入教室，踏上演讲台。
In a crowded building, you walk into a classroom and step onto the podium with a file in your hand.

台下审视的目光难以无视，这份被凝视的感觉熟悉而又令人无所适从。
The scrutinizing gazes coming from below are hard to ignore. It feels both familiar and overwhelming.

伽菈波那：……此次报告，有关于《白矮星 FYDL 82A 在双星系统下的超新星爆炸》……
Kaalaa Baunaa: ... This report given here concerns the work "The Supernova under the Binary Star System of White Dwarf FYDL 82A" ...

他们调整姿态，倾听着你的介绍。他们的素养要求自己先把疑虑与困惑置于之后。
Your audience adjusts their posture and listens to your introduction. They have questions, but their professionalism tells them to wait until the end.

偶尔，他们对着其中的神秘学术语皱一下眉头，仿佛这不是一项严肃的学术报告。
Occasionally, they frown at some of your arcane terms, as if this were not a serious academic report.

更多时候，他们紧绷着脸，将自己当作一位肃穆的君王。
The rest of the time, they keep a stern face, as they see themselves as academic royalty.

伽菈波那：……以上便是此次报告的所有内容，感谢各位与会倾听。
Kaalaa Baunaa: ...This concludes this report, thank you for listening.

台下的人面面相觑，一时之间，教室陷入窒息的安静。
The audience looks at each other, and the silence in the classroom is deafening.

计划书：美 %*& 味……
Proposal: Delicious %*&...

除了你，无人发现怪物趴伏在门口，它仿佛是一把达摩克利斯之剑。
Aside from you, no one notices the monster lurking at the door like the Sword of Damocles.

这将是一场艰难的对弈……
This is going to be a tough battle ...

学者卡普尔
Scholar Kapoor COL-307011

他认真阅读了你的报告，但脸上凝固着无法驱散的疑虑，仿佛看见了一盘难以言说的食物。
He reads your report carefully, but the content does not dispel the doubt on his face—he seems to be looking at a plate of indescribable food.

学者卡普尔：首先——你是一位神秘学家，是吗?
Scholar Kapur: First of all, you are an arcanist, right?

他们对你的底细一清二楚。
They seem to know everything about you.

可你并不感到困惑与惶恐，就像从未隐藏过自己的身份。
But you remain calm and collected, as if you've never hidden your identity before.

伽菈波那：是的。但我认为我的血统与我的研究报告并无关联。
Kaalaa Baunaa: Yes, but I don't think that has anything to do with my report.

连计划书都有一张血盆大口，他们对自己知根知底又有什么好奇怪的?
If research proposals can have a fearful, gaping maws, then what's so strange about them knowing a few things about you?

伽菈波那：您看见报告上的署名了，上面已经清楚标注了我神秘学家的身份。
Kaalaa Baunaa: If you look at my signature on the report, it clearly states that I'm an arcanist.

伽菈波那：我认为这并不值得避讳。
Kaalaa Baunaa: I don't think it's anything to be ashamed of.

你松了一口气。甚至可以说，这样的争辩你等待已久。
You breathe a sigh of relief. You might even say you've waited a long time for this discussion.

学者卡普尔：当然～天文学的大门向任何人敞开，我们——是包容的!
Scholar Kapur: Of course! Everyone is welcome to study astronomy. We astronomers have an open mind.

学者卡普尔：但我在你的运行轨迹数据上，发现其中包含了许多不可能观测到的数据——
Scholar Kapur: But in your report, I found a lot of trajectory data that are impossible to obtain through observation...

学者卡普尔：根据学界的评估，观测这项数据所需的工具尚未有技术生产，我们现存的工具无法达到那样的观测精度。
Scholar Kapur: According to scientific assessments, the technology to build any instruments for these observations doesn't yet exist, and the tools we have cannot provide such precise data.

学者卡普尔：那么，这些数据若非你凭空捏造，便是通过所谓的神秘术——
Scholar Kapur: So either you fabricated the data, or you used to so-called "arcane skills" to—

伽菈波那：那些“不可能观测的数据”并非全由神秘术取得，我参考了大量光谱分析图与过往其他学者的观测，神秘术在其中的参与微乎其微。
Kaalaa Baunaa: This "unobservable data" was not entirely obtained through arcane skills. I referred to a large number of spectrum analysis and observation reports made by other scholars. Arcane skills only played a very small part in this process.

你打断他的话头，对方语气中的戏谑令你皱起了眉头。
You interrupt him, frowning at the rudeness of his tone.

伽菈波那：我在第 24 页中附上了过往占卜的数据，与普通观测的数据对照表，吻合度达到 97%，这个误差完全在可接受范围内。
Kaalaa Baunaa: You can check the divination data in the past years on page 24. It matches 97% of the data obtained by normal means. The margin of error is perfectly acceptable.

学者卡普尔：嗯……确实如此，你的对照非常——详尽。
Scholar Kapur: Hmm ... That's what's been written here. Your comparison is ... exhaustive.

他翻阅着附录，拧紧眉头，陷入长久的沉默。似乎为了缓解尴尬，他示意下一位教授提问。
He frowns as he flips through the appendix and falls into a long silence. As if to ease the discomfort, he gestures for the next professor to ask questions.

学者拉哈尔
Scholar Lahar COL-307012

他不打算掩饰脸上的讥讽，对你的轻蔑显而易见。
He doesn't try to hide his contempt—it's there for all to see.

学者拉哈尔：我不会认同一个神秘学家的研究报告，你们脑子里装的有多少经得起推敲？
Scholar Rahar: I will never approve a report written by an arcanist. I'll say the ideas in your head are hardly worth listening to.

学者拉哈尔：星盘、香料、沙漏……我不是在陪我的小女儿做游戏。
Scholar Rahar: Astrolabe, spice, and hourglass ... It's not a game with my stupid little daughter.

他恼怒地站起来，双手支撑在桌面上。
He stands up in anger and puts his hands on the table for support.

学者拉哈尔：我欢迎你以人类的方式参与研究，但你所有的数据都建立在荒谬之上。
Scholar Rahar: If you do the research in a human way, I'll say nothing but welcome. However, you acquired all those data through absurd methods.

你无动于衷，对此早已司空见惯。
You remain unfazed, long accustomed to this.

伽菈波那：抱歉，您的发问与我的研究内容毫无关联，您仅是在对我进行人身攻击。
Kaalaa Baunaa: Sorry, but your objection has nothing to do with the contents of my research. You are just attacking me personally.

伽菈波那：我不会回应您的期待。不过，允许我向您提个建议——尊重您的小女儿。
Kaalaa Baunaa: I will not respond the way you want, but please allow me to give you a suggestion—respect your daughter.

周围的眼光围堵着拉哈尔，他满脸发烫，慌张地坐了下来。
Burned by the gazes around him, the man flushes and sits down in a panic.

这是根难啃的骨头，不过你还有其他选择。
He is a hard nut to crack, but fortunately you still have other choices.

学者达特
Scholar Dahat COL-307013

他的食指在桌面上敲击，手撑着下颚，似乎在认真地评估着你的报告内容。
One hand supporting his chin, the other tapping the table, this man seems to be evaluating your report seriously.

学者达特：你能解释一下，占卜数据与普通观测的数据对照表上，3%的误差吗?
Scholar Datt: Could you explain the 3% margin of error in the comparison table between the divination data and the normal observation data?

学者达特：3%的误差确实可忽略不计。但我很想知道，这3%不相符的数据上，有什么相同的共性吗?
Scholar Datt: A 3% error is indeed negligible. But I'd like to know if there's a commonality among these inconsistencies.

学者达特：如果这个共性具有普适性，那么你可能存在刻意筛选数据，甚至捏造学术成果的问题。
Scholar Datt: If the commonality is universal, it may indicate that you have manipulated data, or even fabricated results.

伽菈波那：您的观察力很敏锐……我无法自证这一点。
Kaalaa Baunaa: You made a valid point...but I don't have the evidence of something I did not do.

伽菈波那：我可以向您展示更多的比对数据，您可以通过随机筛选来判断我是否存在造假行为。
Kaalaa Baunaa: I can show you more of the collected data. You can do a random check to see if I faked the conclusion.

学者达特：嗯，除此之外我没有其他疑虑了。
Scholar Datt: Alright. I have no further questions.

学者达特：真理并不会因为你是神秘学家而有所偏颇。
Scholar Datt: The truth will remain unaffected, whether you are an arcanist or not.

他点点头，认可了你的研究。
He nods, acknowledging your research.

你不禁松了一口气。
You can't help but heave a sigh of relief.

落幕:对峙时刻
Epilogue: Confrontation COL-307014

你望向门外，怪物已变成野猫般的大小，它心满意足，呼噜噜地吐息。看来演讲的成效显著。
You look outside and see the monster reduced to the size of a cat, purring with satisfaction—your speech was remarkably effective.

台下的人群散去，但下一场质询会近在眼前，你不会有多少喘息的时间。
The crowd disperses, but the next interrogation approaches. You don't have much time to compose yourself.

3#1
3#1

序幕:问答的艺术
Prologue: The Art of Defense COL-307015

伽菈波那： 根据数据，白矮星 FYDL 82A 与伴星之间的间距正在以缓慢的速度缩小。
Kaalaa Baunaa: According to the data, the distance between White Dwarf FYDL 82A and its secondary star is gradually decreasing.

伽菈波那： 它们像两颗旋转着同时落入球洞的玻璃球。不同的是，届时它们不会彼此碰撞、分离……
Kaalaa Baunaa: They are like two circling marbles falling into the same hole, except they will not collide or separate.

伽菈波那： 白矮星将吸收伴星的物质，两者相互交合，产生热核反应。
Kaalaa Baunaa: The white dwarf will absorb matter from the secondary star, after which the two will merge, producing a nuclear fusion.

伽菈波那： 最终，将会发生有史以来，距离地球最近的超新星爆炸……
Kaalaa Baunaa: In conclusion, a supernova that is closer to Earth than any other ones in history will take place ...

会谈所的教授鸦雀无声，他们需要足够的时间吸收这始料未及的信息。
The professors in the conference room are left speechless and need a few moments to digest this shocking reveal.

伽菈波那： 根据现有的数据，我们还无法推测此次超新星爆炸对地球运行轨道的作用。
Kaalaa Baunaa: Our current data is not enough for simulating the supernova's influence on the Earth's orbit.

伽菈波那： 但爆炸所产生的射线……可能对地球上的生物具有——毁灭性的影响。
Kaalaa Baunaa: But its radiation ... can be destructive to the living things on Earth.

你放下研究报告，沉默的会谈所令你感到不安。
You put down the research report, unsettled by the silence in the conference room.

他们是否认可了自己的报告？还是觉得这份报告荒谬至极，以至于无从提问？
Do they see the significance of your report? Or are they speechless because they think it's ridiculous?

亦或者，他们只是被这个危险的结论震惊得无话可说？
Or, are they just too shocked to say a single word?

教授杰定
Professor Jardin COL-307016

教授杰定： 你的研究结论令我们非常震惊，我想你有所预见。
Professor Jardin: Your conclusion shocked us, but I suppose you anticipated this.

伽菈波那： 是的……
Kaalaa Baunaa: Yes...

教授杰定： 你考虑过发布这篇报告后，可能引起的民众恐慌吗？如果你的推测错误，研究所将成为舆论的众矢之的。
Professor Jardin: Have you considered the possible panic it may cause among the public? If your conjecture is wrong, the institution will become the target of public opinion.

选项 / Choices

1. 这不是研究员需要顾及的
1. That is not something a researcher needs to consider.

2. 质疑与恐惧是追寻真理的必经之路
2. Fear and doubt are always present in the search for truth.

分支 / Branch 1

伽菈波那： 我只是察觉并推测存在的可能性，揭露这个可能性是研究员的义务。
Kaalaa Baunaa: It is a researcher's duty to discover and deduce all possibilities. I'm just doing my job.

伽菈波那： 而这个可能性是否会引起公众的恐慌，并不在我的考量范围内。
Kaalaa Baunaa: As for the panic it might cause, that is not part of my consideration.

伽菈波那： 我只负责保证我的研究报告符合《科研诚信协议》。
Kaalaa Baunaa: I am only responsible for ensuring my research report complies with the Research Integrity Agreement.

他摩挲着胡子，紧锁眉头。
He strokes his beard, frowning.

分支 / Branch 2

伽菈波那： 天气预报并不会因预报暴风雨，而受到谴责。
Kaalaa Baunaa: The weatherman should not be condemned for predicting a storm.

伽菈波那： 质疑、恐慌……没有任何一项研究能独善其身，躲开这些。
Kaalaa Baunaa: Doubt, fear... No research can truly be free of these things.

伽菈波那： 我愿意为后续的舆论承担责任，这是我应当付出的代价。
Kaalaa Baunaa: I will take responsibility for the public opinions it may cause. This is a price I'll have to pay.

他叹了口气，却仍旧点了点头。
He sighs, but nods nonetheless.

教授查特吉
Professor Chatterjee COL-307017

教授查特吉：我对你的结论没有异议，你的数据足够完善严谨……
Professor Chatterjee: I have no objection to your conclusion. Your data is certainly rigorous.

教授查特吉：但我好奇的是，你是否研究过防范这种射线的方法？还是说你选择置之不顾。
Professor Chatterjee: But I'm curious. If your prediction is correct, is there any way to protect us from this radiation? Or will you leave this problem to others?

选项 / Choices

1. 我只负责提出问题
1. I'm only responsible for finding problems.

2. 我们别无他法
2. There is only so much we can do.

分支 / Branch 1

伽菈波那：现阶段我们仅能到这一步，至于对该射线的研究分析，暂且还未列上日程。
Kaalaa Baunaa: This is our progress thus far. As for studying and analyzing the radiation, that's not yet on the agenda.

伽菈波那：但如果这个报告通过，我想我可以申请到更多的科研经费进行这项研究。
Kaalaa Baunaa: But if the report is approved, I think I can apply for more funding for further research.

伽菈波那：当然，这同时也是一种赌约……推测与事实并非没有距离。
Kaalaa Baunaa: Of course, this is a prediction ... And we know there is a difference between prediction and reality.

伽菈波那：我无法保证这项“投资”的收益。
Kaalaa Baunaa: I can't be certain that it will go the way I expect.

他松一口气，这些回答令他释怀。
至少他知道你是有所考虑，而非把这个问题抛掷脑后。
He breathes a sigh of relief, reassured by your answer. At least he knows you've thought this through.

分支 / Branch 2

伽菈波那：现阶段的研究无法分析该射线的成分，我无法给出解决方案。
Kaalaa Baunaa: At this time, we are unable to analyze the composition of the radiation. I have no solution.

伽菈波那：这很悲观，但事实如此。我想我们只能把希望寄托于进一步的研究。
Kaalaa Baunaa: It sounds depressing, but it's true. I think our hope lies in further research.

教授查特吉：……看来在弄清它之前，我有一段时间的噩梦可做了。
Professor Chatterjee: ...It seems I'll have some nightmares of my own until we figure this out.

他摇了摇头，摘下眼镜，揉捏着鼻梁。
He shakes his head, takes off his glasses, and rubs the bridge of his nose.

教授拉杰夫
Professor Rajev COL-307018

教授拉杰夫: 我倾向把这看作是一份带着末日论调的报告。
Professor Rajeev: I can't help but see this as a doomsday report.

教授拉杰夫: 不得不承认，这份报告带着很深的神秘学的影子。
Professor Rajeev: You have to admit that this report is heavily influenced by the arcanum.

教授拉杰夫: 我应该如何信任一位神秘学家？我有理由猜测，你试图通过这份报告引起舆论关注，借此让神秘学家崭露头角——像某种宗教。
Professor Rajeev: How can I trust an arcanist? I have reason to believe you're using this report to bring arcanists into the public eye to give them prominence, just as some religions do.

选项 / Choices

1. 这是一种偏见
1. That is a prejudiced notion.

2. 数据是客观的
2. The data does not lie.

分支 / Branch 1

伽菈波那: 末日论……这很荒谬。如果事实如您所说，我现在应该是一位煽动民众的政治家。
Kaalaa Baunaa: Doom-mongering ... How ridiculous. I'd be a politician inciting the masses if that were true.

伽菈波那: 而政治家不需要在您面前进行严谨的证明。
Kaalaa Baunaa: And a politician wouldn't need to prove her ideas so rigorously before you.

教授拉杰夫: 谁又能保证你不是呢?
Professor Rajeev: And who can prove that you're not?

他耐人寻味地看着你，你明白已于事无补。
He looks at you intently. You realize there is nothing more you can do.

分支 / Branch 2

伽菈波那: 星体的运行并不以我的意志为变化。是资料所列出的观测、对照数据，给出了可能性。
Kaalaa Baunaa: The movement of celestial bodies is not influenced by my will. It is the observational and comparative data that predict the possibility.

伽菈波那: 在您看来，神秘学家也许谎话连篇，但数据材料，它比任何东西都诚实。
Kaalaa Baunaa: You may think that arcanists are full of lies, but data will always tell you the truth.

教授拉杰夫: 很聪明的回答……
Professor Rajeev: A smart answer...

教授拉杰夫: 但你是不是一个狡猾的神秘学家，我们拭目以待。
Professor Rajeev: But time will tell what kind of arcanist you are.

落幕:问答的艺术
Epilogue: The Art of Defense COL-307019

长舒一口气，你熬过了质询会，门口的怪物已失去踪影。
You let out a long sigh of relief. You survived the inquiry, and the monster at the door is gone.

起码这下，你不用担心再像一头待宰的羔羊被拖进研究所了。
At least now, you don't have to worry about being dragged back to the institute like a lamb for slaughter.

抛开敌意与质疑，教授们再次向你提出了若干建议，这次是以更加温和的方式。
Hostility and doubts cast aside, the professors give you a few more suggestions, in a gentler way this time.

显而易见，这些建议比质询更有用处，你需要花更多的时间来缝缝补补了……
Obviously, these suggestions are much more useful than their interrogations. It seems you'll have to spend more time perfecting the report ...

伽菈波那：呼……
Kaalaa Baunaa: Whew...

此时，你显然还没有发觉，头顶上悬挂着一颗漆黑的星体……
So far you still have not noticed the black star floating above your head ...

3#1
3#1

序幕:非此即彼
Prologue: Either This or That COL-307020

回到研究所，你对着教授标注的内容忧心忡忡。
Back at the institute, you worry over the professors' highlights in the report.

伴星的运动轨迹数据仍然存在缺漏，但你明白，这并不是一个难题，只是……
There are still data gaps in the orbital trajectory of the secondary star, but you know this won't be an issue, it's just that...

调查观测数据会耗费你大量的精力与时间，而神秘术——会让你更轻松地获取过往的数据，前提是你能接受那“微不足道”的误差。
Examining the observational data will take a lot of energy and time, and arcane skills will get you the previous data more easily, provided you can accept the..."negligible" error.

伽菈波那：嗯……?!
Kaalaa Baunaa: Ouch ...?!

你的头被什么东西重重坠砸，你抬头，黑不溜秋的星体向你示好。
Something just hit your head hard. You look up to find the greeting of a black star.

……你有预感，如果再不做出选择，你那脆弱的颈椎就得提前退休了——不过那也不错?
...You feel that if you don't decide soon, your fragile neck will have to retire early—actually, would that be so bad?

木质圆盘
Wooden Disc COL-307021

褪去木质圆盘的遮布，上面布满藤蔓般繁复的花纹——曼陀罗之花。
Under the cloth is a wooden disc full of vine-like patterns—the flowers of the mandrake.

你选择了最轻松的方式，有人提过你缺点儿冒险精神和耐心吗……?
You chose the easiest way. Has anyone ever mentioned your lack of adventure and patience?

纸张垫上圆盘，你用笔尖临摹出一个圆圈。
You put a piece of paper on the disk, and trace a circle on it.

合上眼，松懈意识，意志之外的力量挪动你的手臂。你听到纸上沙沙作响，秘密杰作正在悄然绘制。
You close your eyes and relax, allowing the power from beyond your mind to take over your arm. You hear the paper rustling, a masterpiece is in the making.

片刻，仿佛脱了线的木偶，你的手停顿下来。
A moment later, your hand stops, as if the strings controlling it were broken.

睁开眼，荒诞、诡谲的画作呈现在你的眼前，这是一张仿佛来自远古洞穴的壁画。
You open your eyes and see an absurd, unusual painting. It looks just like a mural from ancient times.

你抚摸着它，将画作印刻在脑海，旋即合眼。
You touch it, imprinting the drawing in your mind, and close your eyes again.

伽菈波那：呼……现在，集中精力，想象伴星围绕着白矮星的画面……
Kaalaa Baunaa: Phew... Now concentrate. Imagine the secondary star orbiting the white dwarf...

你的脑海内浮现出梦寐以求的画面……
The scenario of your dreams begins to play out in your mind.

库玛尔：——颁奖台，耀眼的聚光灯，库玛尔从席位上站起来，掌声四起。
Kumar: A podium, dazzling spotlights. Kumar rises from her seat, and a shower of applause.

库玛尔：她的微笑扯动着面容，漠然的脸庞一去不返。
Kumar: A smile graces her face, the usual indifference is gone without a trace.

伽菈波那：不，不……再来一遍。
Kaalaa Baunaa: No, no ... Try again.

脑海内再次浮现出心心念念的画面……
The scene of your dreams begins to reappear in your mind...

你集中注意力，马桶冲水的声音突然从远处传来……
You concentrate, but the sound of a flushing toilet is coming from the distance...

——马桶内部，水流旋转而下，两颗漆黑的球体混在水流之中，中间是深不见底的黑暗……
Water spirals down the toilet. Two black spheres are carried by the current, between them a bottomless darkness...

伽菈波那：这是什么……
Kaalaa Baunaa: What's this...?

很显然，水声使你的冥想产生了奇怪的画面……
Clearly, the sound of the water has created a strange image in your meditation.

但你很快发现，浮现的画面中，两颗球体的运动轨迹非常接近之前的……
But soon you notice that the trajectory of the spheres in the water looks just like—

伽菈波那：……
Kaalaa Baunaa: ...

别愁眉苦脸的，好好记录下来这难能可贵的数据吧。
The long face will do you no good. Record the precious data before it goes away.

资料
Documents COL-307022

你驶去天文台，摸着黑进入霉味熏天的资料室。噢，这味道能让你饱上好几天。
You drive to the observatory and feel your way into the moldy reference room. This smell can ruin your appetite for days.

高兴一些，瞧瞧你自己，多么富有冒险精神以及多此一举的魄力?
Cheer up. Look at you, sneaking into the reference room in the middle of night, how adventurous you have become!

伽菈波那：嗯……至少比库玛尔的卧室好一些。
Kaalaa Baunaa: Ugh. At least it's not as bad as Kumar's bedroom...

伽菈波那：那么，关于伴星的旧观测记录在……
Kaalaa Baunaa: So, the past data of the secondary star is...

翻动着成叠的资料本，密密麻麻的虫子从底下倾巢而出。
As you move the pile of documents, a swarm of bugs pours out from the bottom.

伽菈波那：不!!!
Kaalaa Baunaa: NO!!!

一瞬间，你希望手中有一柄火把，将这里付之一炬，连同这些可爱的小生灵……
For a moment, you wish you had a torch so you could burn the place down and kill these cute little buggers.

瞧瞧，枯燥的科研生涯让你变成了多么缺乏怜悯与同情心的孩子?
You see? The tedious life of a researcher has turned you into a child devoid of compassion and sympathy!

伽菈波那：呼……这不算什么。
Kaalaa Baunaa: *sigh* ...I can do this.

你踮起脚尖，屏住呼吸，在满地的资料书中挑挑拣拣。
You tiptoe, hold your breath, and rummage through the data books on the floor.

收获如约而至，你的包里很快装满了所需的资料本。
You pick up a bounty of records, and soon your bag is filled with all the data logs you need.

伽菈波那：哈……哈……呼!
Kaalaa Baunaa: *panting*

逃出了虫窟，美妙的空气充盈你的肺部。
After escaping the insects' nest, sweet air fills your lungs.

一次为了真理的伟大历险，这该被载入神秘学家的史册。
Such an epic adventure in search of truth should be etched into the annals of history.

落幕:非此即彼
Epilogue: Either This or That COL-307023

伽菈波那：这些数据……伴星过去的运动幅度竟然比现在还要剧烈?
Kaalaa Baunaa: These data ... The orbital movement of the secondary star was even more extreme than it is now?!

你细细观察着记录下来的数据，感觉到汗水顺着面颊滑落。
As you read the data, sweat begins to run down your cheeks.

伽菈波那：它与白矮星的距离一度比现在更接近……但到达某个极值后，就回到了轨道上?
Kaalaa Baunaa: It was even closer to the white dwarf in the past ... until it reached a minimum distance and returned to its orbit?!

伽菈波那：我的推测……是错误的?
Kaalaa Baunaa: My prediction...is wrong?

你知道那意味着什么，无止境的推翻重建……如同西西弗斯的诅咒……
You know what this can mean, the endless toil of starting over again, not unlike a Sisyphean punishment...

伽菈波那：不，不，这份数据肯定出错了。要么是观测员，要么是我的疏忽……
Kaalaa Baunaa: No, no, something must be wrong with these data, either the observer or my mistake ...

你急切地想证明这份数据的错误，而可对照的数据副本存放在班纳尔大学的图书馆内。
You eagerly want to prove the data is wrong, but the copy of data for comparison is stored in the Banner University library.

但已时至深夜，图书馆大门紧闭……
Unfortunately it's already late at night, and the library is closed ...

你蠢蠢欲动，如果得不到答案，你将彻夜无眠。
You're itching to act. It will be a sleepless night if you don't get an answer.

还有什么好犹豫的?
Why hesitate?

……

...

……

...

图书馆
Library

伽菈波那：哈……!
Kaalaa Baunaa: Ha...!

你爬入墓园般安静的图书馆。
You sneak into the library, which is quiet as a graveyard.

翻找资料的副本，纸张翻动，副本的内容在你面前飞速地掠过。你注意到，关键的数据处只有一片刻意遗留的空白。
You find the data and quickly flip through the pages, noticing that there are blank spots at where important data should be.

伽菈波那：这是……曾被抹去的痕迹。
Kaalaa Baunaa: These are...remnants of an erasure.

伽菈波那：这本资料的主人曾事无巨细地记录下这组数据的推演过程，却又在后面，彻底将这部分数据抹去……

Kaalaa Baunaa: The owner of this data book had meticulously recorded the deduction process of the data set, only to later delete this part of the data completely...

伽菈波那：这组被抹去的数据，既可能将我的研究课题完全推翻，也可能完美地证实我的发现！

Kaalaa Baunaa: This missing data could either completely overturn my research, or finally prove my findings!

伽菈波那：难以置信，他早就知道我会找到这里……

Kaalaa Baunaa: Unbelievable. He must have known that I would find this place...

伽菈波那：他应当知晓这组数据的重要性。

Kaalaa Baunaa: I'm sure he knew how important this data was.

伽菈波那：那么，他这样做的原因是……

Kaalaa Baunaa: What compelled him to do all this?

“高昂时目空一切，谦卑时方能洞彻道路。”书架上贴着熟悉的诫言。

"In arrogance, all is beneath you. In humility, nothing eludes you." You see a familiar maxim taped to the bookshelf.

你低头，在脚底边，有块书角露了出来。

You lower your head and see the corner of a book by your feet.

这就是你要的答案。

The answer you've been looking for.

打开数据副本资料，很快，观测员签名处出现一个熟悉的名字。

You open the data book, and soon see the familiar signature of the observer.

伽菈波那：……

Kaalaa Baunaa: ...

上面戏谑地写着：库玛尔。

Ironically, it reads "Kumar".

而她自始至终，是最赞同你的研究结论的人。

But yet...she was always been the one who supported your predictions the most.

头顶高悬的星体，摇摇欲坠……

The star hanging above your head wobbles and sways...

3#1

3#1

序幕:群星不再
Prologue: The Fading Stars COL-307024

伽菈波那：如果根据库玛尔过去的观测数据，伴星的轨迹变化就是周期性的……
Kaalaa Baunaa: According to Kumar's past observational data, the secondary star's trajectory changes periodically.

伽菈波那：由远至近，在距离达到极值后，整个运行轨迹都会产生改变。
Kaalaa Baunaa: It approaches the white dwarf until a minimum distance, and then the entire orbital trajectory begins to change.

伽菈波那：那么我所认为的超新星爆炸，便只是一次荒谬的推测，我此前的所有研究将沦为一叠废纸……
Kaalaa Baunaa: Then the supernova explosion I inferred would be nothing more than an absurd conjecture. All my previous research would become a pile of waste paper...

伽菈波那：库玛尔，你到底在想什么?
Kaalaa Baunaa: Kumar, what were you thinking?

伽菈波那：如果我的推测是错误的，这又有什么值得隐藏的?
Kaalaa Baunaa: If my conjecture is wrong, there was no point in hiding it.

伽菈波那：放任我在错误的道路上渐行渐远，白白耗费时间与经费……你又能获得什么呢?
Kaalaa Baunaa: Allowing me to go further and further down the wrong path, all that wasted time and money... What was in it for her?

伽菈波那：看来，我得亲自观测了……
Kaalaa Baunaa: It seems I'll have to observe it myself...

要想证实你的错误，只需要在周期变化的节点日观测伴星，便能得出答案。
To prove your mistake, just observe the secondary star, on its nodal day, and you'll have the answer.

伽菈波那：那么节点日在——
Kaalaa Baunaa: And the nodal day is...

伽菈波那：明天?!
Kaalaa Baunaa: Tomorrow?!

很幸运，有谁能在短短几天内就亲自体验到构筑与坍塌并行的幻灭感呢?
How fortunate... Who else could personally experience both the confirmation and the collapse of their work in just a few days?

事不宜迟，现在紧要的是选择用来观测的望远镜，这可是你的专长……
There's no time to waste. The most pressing matter now is to choose a telescope for observation, which is your specialty...

伽菈波那：光学望远镜，受制于阴霾，却是普通观测中所最常用的工具。
Kaalaa Baunaa: The optical telescope, although hampered by haze, is still the most widely used tool for everyday observations.

伽菈波那：结构简单、价格低廉。我记得不久前，加拉瓦还给他在莫里农的奶奶送过一架……
Kaalaa Baunaa: Simple and affordable. I remember Gaurav sending one to his grandmother in Mawlynnong...

伽菈波那：X 射线望远镜，仅能侦测白矮星爆发后的 X 射线。但这还远不是时候……
Kaalaa Baunaa: The X-ray telescope can only detect X-rays emitted after the white dwarf's eruption. But it's still far from time...

伽菈波那： 至于射电望远镜，能观测到遥远星体的无线电波，不受天气、大气的影响……
Kaalaa Baunaa: And radio telescope ... it can observe the radio waves emitted by distant stars, unaffected by weather and atmosphere...

头顶高悬的星体正在逐渐膨胀，像一颗黑色大煤块。
The celestial body hanging overhead gradually expands, like a canvas of darkness.

看来它不喜欢等你太久。
Looks like its patience is running out.

你望向厚重的云层，若有所思。
You look at the thick clouds, deep in thought.

光学望远镜
Optical Telescope COL-307025

你径直走向天文台的光学望远镜。在这里，你第一次见到了库玛尔，这是一场毕生难忘的观测。
You head straight for the optical telescope at the observatory. That's where you met Kumar for the first time. You will never forget that day.

伽菈波那： 她为什么要隐瞒观测到的数据?
Kaalaa Baunaa: Why did she conceal the observed data?

伽菈波那： 她明知道我的推测……也许根本就是错误的。
Kaalaa Baunaa: She must have known my conjecture was...probably wrong from the start.

抬起手，你抚摸着这台老旧的望远镜……想从它这里问出答案。
You touch the timeworn telescope, wondering if it can tell you the answer.

天文台
Observatory

小伽菈波那： ……
Little Kaalaa: ...

库玛尔： 孩子，你待在这里多久了?
Kumar: Child, how long have you been here?

库玛尔： 你想看看它对吗?
Kumar: You would like to see it, right?

你犹豫地晃着脑袋，像幼犬摇动着它拿不定主意的尾巴。
You bobbed your head hesitantly, like an indecisive puppy wagging its tail.

而她轻轻侧身，向后退一步让出了位置。
She gently moved aside, stepping back to make room.

攥紧拳头，你第一次想握住从未属于自己的东西，由此拐入了一条从未设想的小路。
You clenched your fists. That was the first time you wanted to touch something beyond your reach, which unexpectedly, led you to a future you had never imagined.

你站上台，将眼睛凑近通往宇宙的入口——
You got onto the stage, and brought your eye close to the gateway to the universe ...

伽菈波那： ……
Kaalaa Baunaa: ...

你明白来到这里无济于事，你只是将此当作一次缅怀。
You understand this place won't help you with the problem. This is just a visit for you to reminisce.

至少它让你记起了一些东西。
Well, at least it helped you remember a few things.

X 射线望远镜
X-ray Telescope COL-307026

X 射线望远镜——库玛尔没少用这东西当试金石。
The X-ray telescope—Kumar often used this as a touchstone for spotting the gifted.

你选择了这个?
Are you really going to choose this?

是你的记忆出现差错了吗?研究员的脑容量可不能这么小。
Is your memory failing you? A researcher's brain can't be THIS smooth.

让咱们翻翻你的记忆。
Let's take a little trip down memory lane.

库玛尔: 所以谁也不认识这个东西?
Kumar: So none of you know what it is?

教室里鸦雀无声。学生望着这位高傲的讲师,茫然无措。
The classroom fell silent. The students stared at the arrogant instructor, clueless.

库玛尔: 呵,招生部门不应该把毫无常识的学生扔进我的课堂。
Kumar: Heh. It's ridiculous that Admissions would let you students with no common sense get into my classroom.

库玛尔: 看来他们是指望让我把星体塞进你们空荡荡的脑子里。
Kumar: It seems I'm expected to stuff the wonder of the celestial bodies into your empty heads.

伽菈波那: X 射线望远镜。
Kaalaa Baunaa: An X-ray telescope.

你举起手,交出答案。
You raised your hand, giving the answer.

库玛尔: 嗯?
Kumar: Hm?

她饶有兴趣地瞧着你。
She looked at you with interest.

伽菈波那: 这个望远镜能接收星体所发射出的 X 射线,从而对星体进行分析观测……
Kaalaa Baunaa: This telescope can receive X-rays emitted by celestial bodies for analysis and observation.

伽菈波那: 它被投入在太空中,拥有超远的观测距离。
Kaalaa Baunaa: It's launched into space, and has an extremely long observation distance.

伽菈波那: 但是对那些射线微弱的星体,诸如稳定时期的白矮星,难以观测。
Kaalaa Baunaa: But it doesn't perform well when observing celestial bodies that emit weak rays, such as a stable white dwarf.

你应向她探寻的目光,直视着那双略带笑意的眼睛。
Your expectant gaze met her eyes, which held the hint of a smile.

库玛尔: 不算太坏,你的脑子比他们好使一些。
Kumar: Not bad. At least you're not as empty-headed.

库玛尔： 下课后跟我来一趟。
Kumar: Please come see me after the class.

自那之后，其他学生背地里，开始把你和库玛尔称作“连体婴”。
Since then, the other students have secretly called you and Kumar the "Siamese Twins".

但你难以辩驳，因为事实……相差无几。
You didn't bother to deny it, because the two of you became ... almost inseparable.

你们共事的时间增加，脾性愈发接近。你从她身上汲取着不可多得的智慧与洞察力。
The more time you spent with her, the more you became like her in temperament. Like a sponge, you began to absorb her wisdom and insight.

而你如今却像那些无知的学生，来到了此处——这是在表演某种喜剧吗?
Yet today you come here, like one of those ignorant students—is your life a living comedy?

射电望远镜
Radio Telescope COL-307027

你已经多年没有回到这里。
You haven't been back here for years.

当库玛尔第一次将你领进这里时，她将你视为她唯一的接班人。
When Kumar first brought you here, she saw you as her sole successor.

库玛尔： 射电望远镜能够接收更加遥远的星体的讯息——通过射电辐射。
Kumar: Radio telescopes can receive information from even more distant celestial bodies through radio radiation.

库玛尔： 它不会再像光学望远镜那样，把宇宙的模样粗糙地展现在你面前……
Kumar: Unlike an optical telescope, it won't give you just a rough picture of the universe.

库玛尔： 接收机会把射电辐射信号进行加工，转成可供记录和显示的最终形式。
Kumar: The receiver processes the radiation signals and converts them into their final form for recording and display.

伽菈波那： 也就是说……它不会受到大气、天气的干扰。
Kaalaa Baunaa: Which means ... it works no matter what the weather or the atmosphere is like.

库玛尔： 是的，但它并非人类肉眼的延展。在目所不能及的部分，它以另一角度向我们呈现星体，将画面转换为精确的数据……
Kumar: Yes, but it is not an extension of the human eye. It presents the star to us from a different angle—in precise data.

库玛尔： 尽管白纸黑字有别于深空星海——但你知道的，精准对科研人员来说亦是种浪漫。
Kumar: For most people, numbers on paper and stars in the sky are nothing alike, but the accurate data to us is the same as the stunning night sky to them.

库玛尔： 这是我们的第一课，孩子——当你踏入研究所，你眼中璀璨的星星将不再闪烁。
Kumar: This is our first lesson, child—the moment you enter the research institute, the glittering stars in your eyes will cease to twinkle.

库玛尔： 这片无垠的宇宙会变得枯燥，当你仰望夜空，会发现曾经原始的悸动慢慢离你远去。而这就是探寻秘密的代价。
Kumar: The vast universe will become...tedious. When you look up at the night sky, you will find the primal thrill slowly leaving you. And that is the price of reaching for its secrets.

她将所有的知识倾注于你，将你当成自己的孩子。
She taught you everything she knew and treated you as her own child.

一直到后来，你发现，她只是在培育另一个自己。
Until finally, you realized she was just nurturing another version of herself.

伽菈波那： 开关在……
Kaalaa Baunaa: The switch ...

你打开射电望远镜的开关，屏住呼吸，准备揭晓最终的答案——
You turn on the radio telescope and hold your breath, getting ready for the final reveal...

那么，这究竟是库玛尔的玩笑？还是一次荒谬的失误……
Is this a cruel joke of Kumar's, or a ridiculous blunder?

落幕:群星不再
Epilogue: The Fading Stars COL-307028

你拖着疲惫的身躯，回到研究所。大脑在哀嚎，它前所未有地渴望睡眠。
You drag your weary body back to the institute. Your brain is groaning, craving sleep like never before.

根据射电望远镜的观测，库玛尔的数据从始至终都是正确。
According to the radio telescope's observations, Kumar's data was correct every step of the way.

观测的结果，宣判了你是徒劳无功的落败者——你的研究，是一个荒谬的错误。
The observation results are a death sentence, condemning you as a failure, your research nothing more than an absurd mistake.

而库玛尔早就知道这一点，但她从没有试图提醒你。毕竟，这是你的研究。
And Kumar had known this all along, but remained silent. After all, it was your research.

电流在灯泡之间窜动，房间忽明忽暗。
Electricity arcs inside the light bulb, and the room pulsates between light and darkness.

这是线路的旧毛病，翻改一切的代价如此高昂，容忍不便早已成为了大家的共识。
It's an old problem with the wiring—tolerating its inconvenience has long been the consensus.

可弊病会犹如债台般高筑，直至一切摇摇欲坠、分崩离析，无法挽回。
But the flaws will pile up like an insurmountable debt, until everything wobbles and falls apart, beyond salvation.

黑暗如一只大象，在房间坐了下来。
The darkness descends upon the room like an unpleasant intruder.

它沉甸甸的，和你如出一辙。
It is heavy, as are your feelings.

周围空无一人，研究报告正被你攥在手里，你闭上眼睛——睁开。
There is no one around. Holding the report tightly, you close your eyes ... and open them again.

伽菈波那： 我早该知道……关于这一切的研究在她眼里只是小小的一环。
Kaalaa Baunaa: I should have known...this entire research was just a small part of her plan.

伽菈波那： 她从我进入研究所的那一刻，就不再把我当作一位学生……
Kaalaa Baunaa: From the moment I entered the institute, she no longer saw me as a student...

焰尖燃起，火在纸上攀爬。
Flames ignite, crawling up the paper.

你知道，这只是人类与神秘学家万千毫无意义的脉络中，其中最微不足道的一段。
You know this is just one insignificant segment among the countless, meaningless threads between mankind and arcanists.

半途而止的路途，再无打开的书籍，一颗悬在半空、未被锤入的铁钉……
A journey left unfinished, a chapter left unconcluded, and a theory left unproofed...

伽菈波那：库玛尔，希望这是你留给我最后的教训……
Kaalaa Baunaa: Kumar, I hope this is the last lesson you left me...

你看着即将燃尽的报告，黑色碎屑飘在半空中，字在逐渐消失……
The report burns. Words turn to ash and dissolve into the air...

“伴星运行轨迹稳定，不过有少量观测数据存在异常变化。但数据量过少，将此判断为观测误差。”
"The secondary star's trajectory is consistent, but there are small anomalies in some of the observational data. The amount of such anomalous data is scarce, and was considered an observational error."

伽菈波那：?！……等等！
Kaalaa Baunaa: ?! ...Wait!

伽菈波那：这样的话……
Kaalaa Baunaa: In that case...

伽菈波那：……！
Kaalaa Baunaa: ...!

你伸出手，试图把火焰熄灭，但它化为最后一片碎屑消失在你手掌中。
You try to put out the fire, but what's left of the report turns to dust in the palm of your hand.

3#1
3#1

序幕:星体与神话
Prologue: Celestial Bodies and Mythologies COL-307029

咬着食指，双眼注视着空无一物的桌面。
Biting your finger, you stare at the empty table.

这并非一条无归的路，研究所还留存有报告的副本……
Not all is lost, though. There are still copies of the report archived at the institute.

伽菈波那：如果那是观测误差，为什么库玛尔的观测数据也有同样的异常?
Kaalaa Baunaa: If that was an observational error, why were there the same anomalies in Kumar's data as well?

伽菈波那：之前我一直没有意识到……库玛尔运用神秘术所获得的观测数据，与普通观测数据之间也有着惊人相似的 **3%**的误差！
Kaalaa Baunaa: I hadn't noticed this before... The dataset Kumar obtained through arcane skills also has an eerily similar **3%** error!

伽菈波那：3%……质询会上，卡普尔和达特同样也对我的误差表示过怀疑。
Kaalaa Baunaa: A 3% error... At the inquiry, Kapur and Datt also expressed doubts about it.

伽菈波那：这是巧合……？不，不可能。
Kaalaa Baunaa: Is this a coincidence...? No, it can't be.

伽菈波那：除非，我和库玛尔掉进了同一个窟窿，在某个同样的地方犯了差错……！
Kaalaa Baunaa: Unless...Kumar and I fell into the same trap, and made the same mistake!

一股震颤，犹如电流窜过。
You feel a tremor, as if electricity is running through you.

伽菈波那：轨迹的变化，是不是同样遵循着某种既定的规律……
Kaalaa Baunaa: Is it possible the changes of the orbit follow a certain pattern?

你挪开桌椅，把所有观测记录本都在地面上一一摊开。
You push the desk and chairs aside, and spread all the observation logs on the floor.

伽菈波那：……
Kaalaa Baunaa: ...

你无法从中分析出共同的影响因素——事实上，许多错误的研究结论，都源自对巧合缺乏敬畏之心。
You can't figure out what common factor is influencing your research and Kumar's. The truth is, many wrong false conclusions stem from a lack of respect for coincidences.

伽菈波那：不可能……这些数据的“误差”时间如出一辙。
Kaalaa Baunaa: No way ... These "errors" happened at nearly the same time in every dataset...

看来你已笃定要在“规律”的框架里行走。
You are determined to get to the bottom of this once and for all.

祝你好运。
There is work to be done.

布满灰尘的书籍
Dusty Bookshelf COL-307030

晨光铺上地面，你对照着数据分析了一整夜，仍旧一无所获。
Morning light spills on the ground. You spent the entire night analyzing the data, but found nothing.

吞下一杯咖啡，倚靠在柜子底下，你看着窗外苏醒的世界，时间已不多了。
Gulping down a cup of coffee, you lean against a file cabinet and watch the world outside awaken. There isn't much time left.

但地上的那本书是什么？你好像记得……
Wait, what's that book on the ground? You seem to remember it ...

伽菈波那：……我一直以为把它弄丢了。
Kaalaa Baunaa: ... I thought I lost it.

《星体简史（神话汇编）》，它被尘土覆盖。你拿起来，拍了拍封面。
"A Brief History of Celestial Bodies (Mythological Compilation)". You pick it up and pat the dust off it.

书脊上贴着标签“班纳尔小学图书馆藏书”。这所图书馆该把你列入读者黑名单。
The spine is labeled "Banner Elementary School Library". This library really should put you on their blacklist.

伽菈波那：“浮士德星的起源”……
Kaalaa Baunaa: "The Origin of Faust Stars"...

伽菈波那：“那时，宇宙未具雏形，漆黑、寂静，仿若一口深井。”
Kaalaa Baunaa: "In the beginning, the universe was shapeless, dark and silent, like a bottomless well."

伽菈波那：“一粒尘埃，坠落在无边无际的黑暗中，他便是最初的浮士德。”
Kaalaa Baunaa: "A speck of dust, falling into the endless darkness, was the primordial Faust."

伽菈波那：“他圈出自己的领地，国王般守候着秩序，但这是一片没有臣民的疆域。”
Kaalaa Baunaa: "He marked out his territory, safeguarding peace and order as would a king, but it was a land without subjects."

一段歪歪扭扭的灰色笔迹，趴伏在字句下方。
A crooked, gray scribble is scrawled below the words.

伽菈波那：这里的划线……
Kaalaa Baunaa: This writing...

你记起来，那是一只比小拇指还短的铅笔所画就的。
You remember it was written with a pencil shorter than your pinky.

伽菈波那：“他圈出自己的领地，国王般守护着秩序，但这是一片没有臣民的疆域。”
Kaalaa Baunaa: "He marked out his territory, safeguarding peace and order as would a king, but it was a land without subjects."

你端着书本，而她聚精会神地端着下巴。
You held the book, while she propped her chin attentively.

女孩：哇哦，就像我们棚屋的萨卡什老师……
Girl: Wow, just like Teacher Sakash from our hut...

女孩：她跟我们说，一开始棚屋里面也是什么也没有，只有几块烂木头。
Girl: She told us there was nothing in the hut at first—just some rotten planks.

女孩：谁也不想跟着她学，他们都说，与其在那里对着几个数字干瞪眼儿，还不如去放牛赚点儿薄饼钱呢。
Girl: No one wanted to learn from her... They all said, instead of staring at numbers, they might as well go herd cows to earn some money for chapati!

伽菈波那：我很遗憾，她是位好老师……
Kaalaa Baunaa: That's a shame, she sounds like a good teacher.

女孩：嘿嘿，没关系，那只是暂时的。
Girl: Heh heh, don't worry. It was only temporary.

女孩：后来放牛的萨尔曼偷偷站在窗口，留下了一把尺子。再后来，车夫家的塔西姆搬来缺了腿的桌凳……人就越来越多了。
Girl: Later, the cowherd Salman stood quietly by the window and left a ruler behind. Soon after, Taseem from the cart driver's family brought over a table and bench each missing a leg... Over time, more and more people came.

女孩：萨卡什老师告诉我们天上的星星比米缸里的米粒还多。
Girl: Teacher Sakash told us there are more stars in the sky than grains of rice in a pot.

女孩：虽然那时我还没数过星星，但米粒我可数过。萨卡什老师说得一点儿也没错！
Girl: I haven't counted the stars, but I sure have counted grains of rice. Teacher Sakash is absolutely right!

她挠了挠头。
She scratched her head.

女孩：但后来，她又说，米缸里的米粒总有一天会多过天上的星星……我真不明白。
Girl: But then she said, the rice grains in the pot will one day outnumber the stars in the sky... That really confuses me.

伽菈波那：你下次可以和她一起过来，我很欢迎你们。
Kaalaa Baunaa: You can come with her next time, you'll be very welcome.

她落寞地摆过脸。
She turned her face away dejectedly.

女孩： 这儿太高了，太远了。而且，我是来数星星的，我已经得到答案了。
Girl: It's too high, and too far from here. Besides, I came to count the stars and I've already got my answer.

女孩： 萨卡什老师是错的，天上的星星那么多，米粒永远也不可能多过它们。
Girl: Teacher Sakash is wrong. There are so many stars in the sky that grains of rice can never outnumber them.

女孩： “老师也会犯错”，这是她告诉我的。
Girl: "Teachers make mistakes too", that's what she told me.

她掏出铅笔，留下中止故事的句点。
She took out a pencil and left a dot to mark the end of the story.

女孩： 我该走了，今天就读到这里吧，谢谢你……
Girl: I should get going. Let's stop here for today, thank you...

伽菈波那： 等等，你什么时候会再过来?
Kaalaa Baunaa: Wait, when will you come back again?

女孩： 我……我不知道。棚屋要拆掉了，我们正在找新地方。
Girl: I...I don't know. The hut is getting demolished, so we're looking for a new place.

女孩： 等我们找到新的棚屋，我会再回来找你！如、如果我没有回来的话……
Girl: Once we find a new hut, I'll come back to find you! I-if I don't come back...

她一笔一划地在书页上写着什么。
She wrote something on the page, one stroke at a time.

女孩： 你可以到这里找我！
Girl: You can come find me here!

伽菈波那： 而我却再也没有见过她……
Kaalaa Baunaa: Yet I never saw her again...

你翻开下一页，却发现书籍已经散佚。
You turn the page and find that part of the book gone.

一股迫切呼唤着你，像是种……不明的内疚。
Something urges you on, like a...faint sense of guilt.

俯下身，你克制住对秽物的厌恶，找寻起留有地址的缺页。
Leaning down, you hold back the urge to retch, looking for the missing page with the address.

散页·其二
Loose Page: Two COL-307031

库玛尔： ……如果完全依照人类的研究方式，以我们的经费，大概连仪器都凑不齐。
Kumar: ... If we completely rely on human research methods, with our funding, we probably can't even secure the necessary equipment.

库玛尔： 善用捷径，孩子。别试图用他们的方式取胜。
Kumar: Make good use of shortcuts, child. Don't try to win by their rules alone.

伽菈波那： 可那些由神秘术所得来的数据，并不完全精确……那会直接影响研究结果。
Kaalaa Baunaa: But data obtained through arcane skills isn't entirely accurate... It will directly affect the research results.

库玛尔：我并没有让你厚此薄彼，你可以利用人类的观测数据来保证研究结果，而神秘术，则让你永远快他们一步。
Kumar: I'm telling you, cast aside your preferences. You can use human observational data to validate your research, while using arcane skills to always stay one step ahead of them.

她坐下来，重新把头埋进成叠的资料里。
She sat back down, burying her head in the piles of documents.

库玛尔：你还站在这里做什么。
Kumar: Why are you still here?

伽菈波那：我……有一本书丢在这里了。
Kaalaa Baunaa: I...left a book here.

库玛尔：……是这本吗？我以为是那个愣头愣脑的男孩带过来的。
Kumar: Is it this one? I thought it belonged to that dimwitted intern.

她把书本丢过来，书页却哗哗地脱落在地。
She threw the book at you, its pages rustling as it fell to the ground.

库玛尔：抱歉，我撕下几页当了稿纸。如果你需要，可以再去买一本。报在研究经费里。
Kumar: Sorry, I tore out some pages to use as draft paper. You can buy another copy if you need it. Just make a note in the research budget.

自始至终她都没有抬头。
She didn't look up the whole time.

伽菈波那：不用了……
Kaalaa Baunaa: There's no need...

你捡拾起书页，匆匆离开了令人窒息的办公室。
You picked up the pages and hurried out of that stifling office.

页码指明这是书籍的结尾，中间的部分仍不知所踪。
The last page is still in the book, but some pages in the middle are missing.

你推开办公桌，口香糖、碎纸屑、粪便颗粒、营养棒……还有一只酣睡的老鼠。
You push away the desk—chewing gum, scraps of paper, pellets of feces, cereal bars...and a sleeping rat.

——它怀里抱着一张未啃完的书页。噢，幸亏它有不浪费食物的好习惯。
There is an unfinished page in its arms. Thank goodness it's not a fast eater.

散页·其一
Loose Page: One COL-307032

你夺下老鼠的口粮，它吱吱哀叫，逃出了办公室。嗯……希望你不会为此感到愧疚。
You snatch the page from the rat. It squeaks and scurries out of the office. Well ... hopefully you don't feel guilty about that.

伽菈波那：这应该就是中间的书页……
Kaalaa Baunaa: This is probably the missing page ...

铺平、展开，皱巴巴的书页还原了本来的模样。
Flattening and unfolding it, you restore the crumpled page to its original form.

可上面的地址已经无影无踪。
But the address on it is nowhere to be found.

伽菈波那：这是怎么回事……
Kaalaa Baunaa: What is going on...

伽菈波那：我记得——
Kaalaa Baunaa: I remember...!

啊，于是你记起来了，是那名愣头愣脑的男孩。
Yes, you remember that dimwitted intern.

伽菈波那：时间到了，你已经可以走了，加拉瓦。
Kaalaa Baunaa: That's it for today. You can go now, Gaurav.

见习生加拉瓦：好、好的，伽菈波那女士……但我还要再待一会儿，这份谱线数据我得再核对一遍。
Intern Gaurav: O-okay, Ms. Kaalaa Baunaa... But I think I'll stay a while longer. I need to double check this data on the spectral lines.

伽菈波那：明天见。
Kaalaa Baunaa: See you tomorrow then.

一只手却拦住了你。
A hand stopped you.

见习生加拉瓦：抱歉，这是你的书吗……伽菈波那女士?
Intern Gaurav: Sorry, is this your book ... Ms. Kaalaa Baunaa?

伽菈波那：嗯……是的。
Kaalaa Baunaa: Yes...it is.

见习生加拉瓦：我妈妈以前经常给我读这个故事，很抱歉……我刚才擅自翻阅了。
Intern Gaurav: My mother used to read me this story. I'm very sorry...I flipped through it just now without permission.

见习生加拉瓦：这一页上面，似乎是库玛尔女士所抄下的数据……
Intern Gaurav: This page seems to have data copied down by Ms. Kumar...

那股不快的感觉再次浮上来。
...That unpleasant feeling again.

伽菈波那：麻烦帮我清理掉吧。
Kaalaa Baunaa: Get rid of it for me.

你记得你头也不回地走了。
You remember leaving without looking back.

事情水落石出，那段地址与数据一起，由你亲手抹去了。
The truth comes out. It was you who erased the address and the data.

但另一条信息，忽然从你脑海中飞窜而过。
But something else springs to mind.

伽菈波那：等等，等等——“谱线数据”?
Kaalaa Baunaa: Wait, wait... "Data on the spectral lines"?

真相的丝迹冒了出来。
A kernel of truth emerges.

伽菈波那：加拉瓦实际上分清楚了单体恒星和分光双星!?……他的数据并没有错。
Kaalaa Baunaa: Gaurav was actually able to distinguish single stars from binary stars!? Then... his data wasn't wrong!

你恍然大悟，跑回研究室，拾起图纸，一张张对应……
With this realization, you run back to the lab, take out the diagrams, and match them up one by one...

有另一个答案在你脑海中浮现。
Another answer emerges in your mind.

落幕:星体与神话
Epilogue: Celestial Bodies and Mythologies COL-307033

伽菈波那：加拉瓦一直以来的记录事无巨细……他从来没有疏漏过。
Kaalaa Baunaa: Gaurav had been meticulously recording data all along, he never missed a thing.

伽菈波那：是我和库玛尔用神秘术观测得到的数据，误导了整个团队！
Kaalaa Baunaa: It was me and Kumar, using data obtained through arcane skills, who misled the whole team!

你洞见了一切，却为时已晚。
The truth no longer eludes you, but it is too late.

堆叠的纸页被翻来覆去，眼睛从一处又紧接到另一处。
You flip the papers back and forth, your eyes darting from place to place.

伽菈波那：不、不，没那么简单……用我们神秘术所获取的数据，结合加拉瓦的观测分析，已经有了一种新的可能……！
Kaalaa Baunaa: No, it's not that simple... With the data we got through arcane skills, combined with Gaurav's analysis, there's a new possibility...!

伽菈波那：另一颗尚未发现的恒星！
Kaalaa Baunaa: Another undiscovered star!

伽菈波那：如果，有一颗恒星仅在变化节点才会出现……而其余时间，它都隐匿在无法观测到的地方。
Kaalaa Baunaa: What if this star only appears at the orbit's nodal points of change, and is beyond detection at other times?

你圈出节点，一步步推翻自己的所有研究。这些劳苦，在发现新恒星的存在面前显得不值一提。
You circle the nodal points, overturning your research step by step. In the face of discovering a new star, this labor seems inconsequential.

伽菈波那：有一颗迄今都未发现的恒星，间断性地对伴星产生吸引……每当濒临超新星爆炸的边缘，它就会将它牵引回正确的轨道。
Kaalaa Baunaa: An undiscovered star that intermittently attracts the secondary star... Whenever the binary star is on the verge of a supernova, it pulls the secondary star back into the proper orbit.

伽菈波那：库玛尔，这场对局比你想象的更有趣……
Kaalaa Baunaa: This game is more interesting than you thought, Kumar.

将乱七八糟的研究室抛之脑后，你重回天文台。头顶的星体欣然跟从，认可了你的抉择。
Leaving the mess in the institution behind, you go back to the observatory. The star above your head happily follows as an approval of your decision.

射电望远镜只需避开太阳射电峰值，没有白昼与黑夜的限制。
Aside from avoiding the peaks of solar radio emissions, the radio telescope has no other limitations.

你的心脏被紧紧攥住，犹如握在手中。
Your heart is being squeezed, as if you were holding it in your hand.

伽菈波那： 那么，最终的结果……
Kaalaa Baunaa: So, the conclusion is ...

3#1

3#1

序幕:尘埃与星
Prologue: Dusts and Stars COL-307034

……

...

夜幕下，威廉·赫歇尔的交响曲在天文台飘荡。
Under the night sky, William Herschel's symphony echoes throughout the observatory.

1758 年，当这位音乐家在演奏厅徜徉时，想必他未曾想过，自己未来将取得许多天文学家一生都难以企及的成就……
In 1758, when the musician was at the concert hall, he probably never imagined that he would one day accomplish what many astronomers have struggled a lifetime to achieve...

——发现太阳系中的第七颗行星，天王星。
Discovering Uranus, the seventh planet in the solar system.

起初，是一本流行的科普读物——书中滑稽地认为彗星与太阳上，有着像人类一般的生物栖息。
It all started with a popular science book—which absurdly claimed that there were human-like creatures living on comets and the sun.

他先是通过普通的折射望远镜观测那些遥远的星体……试图观测星体上的生物。
So he tried to look for these living things on the distant celestial bodies...through a refracting telescope.

模糊不清的画面令他大失所望。他只得耗费大量的精力与财富，自行磨制了望远镜。
The blurred images disappointed him greatly. He had no choice but to spend great efforts and a large sum of money building his own telescope.

伽菈波那： 但他并未观测到星体上的生物，而是——发现了被天文学家忽视、遗忘的一颗行星，从此声名鹊起，举世瞩目。
Kaalaa Baunaa: But he didn't find any life on the celestial bodies. Instead, he discovered a planet overlooked and neglected by astronomers, and became famous overnight, attracting worldwide attention.

伽菈波那： “你对失去高位如此恐惧，以为它的好处无可替代；而好处，却往往另辟蹊径，降临在你身旁。”
Kaalaa Baunaa: "You fear the loss of status so much, thinking its benefits irreplaceable; yet the benefits often find another way, befalling you."

伽菈波那： “命运啊，喜爱这种颠倒的把戏，它使你朝着一个方向掷出希望的种子，但最终却在你未曾意想的地方，长出一棵参天大树。”
Kaalaa Baunaa: "Fate loves this kind of reversal, casting the seeds of hope in one direction, only to grow a towering tree in a place you never expected."

夜幕降临，星光显现。你深叹一口气，无垠的宇宙并未如期给予回应。
Night falls, revealing the stars in the sky. You sigh as the boundless universe has not given you the answer you expected.

幸运之神没有眷顾你，根本不存在尚未被发现的恒星……
The god of fortune does not smile on you; an undiscovered star simply does not exist...

星座
Constellation COL-307035

黑暗的幕布上，开始浮现星星点点的光亮。
On the dark pall of the night sky, specks of light appear one after another.

猎户座、大犬座……它们由无规则的星体组成。人们出于对自然的模仿，赋予它们名字。
Orion, Canis Major... they are made up of irregular celestial bodies. People named them in imitation of nature.

伽菈波那：无数次的推翻、重构，点燃希望的火苗，却以事与愿违的真相扑灭。
Kaalaa Baunaa: I negated my own theory and rebuilt it again and again. Every time I found the spark of hope in the darkness, the truth just put it out against my will.

靠在天文台的栏杆上，脚下是渺小丛密的森林。你放弃了观测，久违地观赏着星空。
You lean against the railing of the observatory, a vast, dense forest lies below. You stop observing and look up at the night sky you've missed for so long.

多少人类被这片奇观触动，由此推开了天文学的大门?
How many people have been inspired by this celestial wonder and entered the realm of astronomy?

亮度、距离、寿命——他们以人类的尺度衡量这些美丽的星辰，以文字与数字去描述它们，为它们立下坐标。
Luminosity, distance, lifespan—they measure these beautiful celestial bodies by human standards, describe them in words and numbers, and assign them coordinates.

伽菈波那：美索不达米亚的神秘学家，如果看到现在的天文学，大概会歇斯底里，想把关于人类天文学的一切付之一炬……
Kaalaa Baunaa: If the arcanists of Mesopotamia saw what human astronomy is like now, they would go mad and try to tear it all down...

伽菈波那：他们观测了数以万计的星星，将这些星群称以生命，最后构筑出伟大的星座体系。
Kaalaa Baunaa: They observed tens of thousands of stars, called these star clusters living beings, and eventually built a magnificent celestial system.

伽菈波那：收集星象的征兆，汇编成指导人类前行的观星手册，却最终因诚实的预言而被绞死……
Kaalaa Baunaa: They recorded all the astronomical phenomena and compiled them into records that guided mankind, only to be sentenced to death for their predictions and forecasts ...

当时库玛尔站在讲台前，你深深记得，那是她唯一动容过的模样。
Kumar stood in front of the podium. That was the only time you saw her emotionally moved.

库玛尔：……3 个月前，考古学家在底格里斯河附近，发现了写有楔形文字的石板。
Kumar: ...Three months ago, archaeologists discovered cuneiform tablets near the Tigris River.

库玛尔：美索不达米亚被绞死的天文学家，在石板上，留下这样的话语——
Kumar: The Mesopotamian astronomers who were punished by death left these words on the tablets —

库玛尔：“我们曾以方寸躯体，丈量无垠；以须臾的存在，记载永恒。”
Kumar: "We once measured the infinite with our insignificant bodies, and recorded eternity in our fleeting existence."

库玛尔：“无须铭记，无须附庸。我们消亡，而真理永在……”
Kumar: "No need to remember, no need to pander. We perish, but truth remains eternal..."

库玛尔：无论你们将来身处何处，谨记这句规训……这就是我们的意义。
Kumar: No matter where you end up in the future, keep these words to heart ... They are the very essence of our existence.

星体
Celestial Body COL-307036

寻找真理的丝迹，需要你付出多少代价?
What is the price we must pay for a kernel of truth?

若被证明付诸一生的理论，是一场谬误，我们何以不崩塌?
If our theory of lifelong devotion is proven wrong, how are we to not collapse and still carry on?

我们无法不因代价痛苦，但只有我们弃绝它，才能转向另一条，也许是真理的道路。
The pain is an inevitable cost that we must bear. Only by concluding this chapter can we move on to a new path, perhaps one that leads to the truth.

伽菈波那：我想我准备好了……
Kaalaa Baunaa: I think I'm ready ...

你伸出手，摩挲着头顶的星体。似乎与它达成了共识。
You reach out, stroking the celestial body above your head, as if you've reached an understanding with it.

它离开你，飘浮到空旷地，缓缓升空，最终消失在视线尽头……
It starts to ascend, first floating in the air, then the sky, and at last towards the end of sight ...

放弃无疾而终的理论，你难抑悸动，却长长舒了一口气。
Having abandoned a theory doomed to failure, you can barely contain your sadness. Nevertheless, you breathe a long sigh of relief.

你为什么要仰望宇宙?
Why do you want to look at the universe?

女孩：那是我唯一没人能拿走的东西，唔……还有这件破洞的衬衫!
Girl: It's the one thing that no one can take from me, um ... one of the two things, I still have this broken shirt!

女孩：星星不会死掉，也不用吃东西，没有人能把它们买下来。
Girl: Stars don't die, and they don't need to eat. No one can occupy them by spending money.

见习生加拉瓦：它，它很漂亮……嗯?理由不够充分?
Intern Gaurav: Th-They are so beautiful ... Hmm? Not a good reason?

见习生加拉瓦：唔……我有个奶奶在莫里农，电话里，这是我们唯一能一起看见的东西。
Intern Gaurav: Well ... My dadi is in Mawlynnong. The stars are the only one thing we can watch together when we're on the phone.

研究员希玛妮：堆满脏盘子的洗碗池、没完没了的家务活……我想从这里逃出来。
Researcher Himani: The sink full of greasy dishes, endless housework ... I want to run away from them.

研究员希玛妮：即便是在鼾声和止不住的哭闹里，只要仰望它，我就能确定，我是属于自己的。
Researcher Himani: Even though life was filled with unstoppable snores and cries, I knew I was living for myself as long as I still saw the stars.

库玛尔：……
Kumar: ...

库玛尔：因为它就呆在那儿。
Kumar: Because they are just, there.

小伽菈波那：我饿肚子的时候，就会躺在屋顶上，看着它。
Little Kaalaa: When I am hungry, I always lie on the roof and look at the stars.

小伽菈波那：它们像钻石一样闪烁……总有一天我会把它们都摘下来，把我的口袋塞得鼓鼓的。
Little Kaalaa: They twinkle just like diamonds ... I wish I could pick them off one day and put them all in my pocket.

小伽菈波那：然后用它们换牛圈那么大的薄饼！
Little Kaalaa: Then I'll exchange them for a neer dosa as large as a corral!

他们的身影交叠，又一一消散。
Their shadows overlap, then fade away one by one.

你伸出手，用食指与拇指框出一片区域——那是白矮星 FYDL 82A 的位置。
You reach out, framing an area with your index and thumb—the location of the White Dwarf FYDL 82A.

伽菈波那：我会记得你的，小家伙……
Kaalaa Baunaa: I will remember you, little star ...

它意识到了你的存在，开始闪烁……
It senses your existence and starts to flicker ...

可它似乎有些异常，变得愈发闪耀，恍惚间成了一颗鹅卵石大的光点。
But something is not right, it gets brighter and brighter until it becomes the size of a pebble.

伽菈波那：超新星爆炸?!
Kaalaa Baunaa: A supernova?!

你难以置信地望着它，光线刺眼而来，万物无所遁形。
You stare in disbelief. The blinding light engulfs everything in sight.

它灼烧你的皮肤，刺痛迎面……!
It burns your skin, and stings your face...!

落幕:尘埃与星
Epilogue: Dusts and Stars COL-307037

伽菈波那：哈！……哈！
Kaalaa Baunaa: Ugh! *pants*

你于惊醒中环顾四周，汗液浸湿了背部。
You wake up startled, shirt soaked in sweat.

见习生加拉瓦：你，你还好吗？伽菈波那女士。
Intern Gaurav: Are-Are you alright, Ms. Kaalaa Baunaa?

加拉瓦站在窗户边，手上拿着窗帘。
Gaurav stands by the window, holding the curtains.

你用手掌挡住刺眼的阳光，让他把窗帘拉了回去。
You block the glaring sunlight with your hand and tell him to pull back the curtains.

伽菈波那：……一场梦吗?
Kaalaa Baunaa: ... A dream?

扶着额头，眩晕感仍然没有散去。
You support your head, still feeling dizzy.

躺在桌上的研究报告，整齐如新。上面并没有任何关于神秘学家的署名。
The research report on the desk is as fresh as new. No arcanist's name is signed on it.

你仍安然地躲藏，以人类的身份。
You are still safely hidden, disguised as a human.

伽菈波那：我记得那本书还在……
Kaalaa Baunaa: I remember that book, it should be here somewhere...

新的念头生起，催促着你朝着与梦境相反的方向行进。
New thoughts arise, urging you to take a different path from the one in the dream.

伽菈波那：找到了。
Kaalaa Baunaa: Found it.

书页中，残留的笔迹仍可依稀辨认。
On the page, what's left of the writing is still vaguely discernible.

这是一份迟到已久的约定。
This is an appointment long overdue.

伽菈波那：加拉瓦，我想拜托你帮个忙。
Kaalaa Baunaa: Gaurav, I'd like to ask you a favor.

伽菈波那：车钥匙在桌子上，请载我去这个地址……
Kaalaa Baunaa: Please drive me to this address, the car keys are on the table.

你指着残损的笔迹，就像她仍在执拗地邀请你到来一般。
You point to the faded writing, as if she were still stubbornly inviting you to come.

见习生加拉瓦：好、好的……
Intern Gaurav: O-okay...

伽菈波那：另外——
Kaalaa Baunaa: Also—

一张填单奉上了他的桌面。
You put a form on his desk.

伽菈波那：你……考虑过正式成为研究员吗?
Kaalaa Baunaa: Have you...considered becoming formal researcher?

3#2
3#2